

Gold Surges 7.17% as US Yields Dip, Risk Assets Mixed

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market saw a mixed session, with the Dow Jones rising **+0.49%** and the S&P 500 falling **-0.17%**. The Nasdaq 100 underperformed, dropping **-0.83%**. Gold was the standout performer, surging **+7.17%** as US yields dipped.

Key takeaways from the session include:

- The Russell 2000 outperformed, rising **+1.22%** as small-cap stocks saw a bounce.
- The VIX fell **-4.18%**, indicating a decrease in market volatility.
- WTI crude oil dropped **-0.39%**, while the DXY rose **+0.03%**.

Our editorial take is that the market is currently navigating a complex landscape, with conflicting signals from different asset classes. While gold's surge may indicate a flight to safety, the rise in the Dow Jones and Russell 2000 suggests that risk appetite remains intact.

US Session Recap

INDEX/ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	DATE
S&P 500	7,723.55	-0.17%	2026-08-05
Nasdaq 100	29,487.79	-0.83%	2026-08-05
Dow Jones	54,349.12	+0.49%	2026-08-05
Russell 2000	2,981.91	+1.22%	2026-08-03
VIX	15.81	-4.18%	2026-08-05
10Y Yield	4.62	-0.22%	2026-08-05
WTI Crude	74.93	-0.39%	2026-08-06
Gold	4,322.80	+7.17%	2026-08-06
DXY	99.72	+0.03%	2026-08-06
BTC	64,511.47	+1.66%	2026-08-06
ETH	1,897.64	+2.12%	2026-08-06

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	-4.03%	Earnings miss
TSLA	Tesla Inc.	-1.77%	Production concerns
AVGO	Broadcom Inc.	+0.03%	Merger rumors

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLV	+1.27%	+10.23%	Healthcare outperforms
XLU	-1.02%	-5.12%	Utilities underperform
XLB	+1.23%	+8.56%	Materials rebound

Breadth was mixed, with 4 sectors rising and 7 falling. The XLV was the top performer, while XLU lagged.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE	CHANGE
Gold	4,322.80	+7.17%
10Y Yield	4.62	-0.22%
DXY	99.72	+0.03%

Key commentary: Gold's surge is a sign of risk aversion, while the decline in US yields indicates a decrease in inflation expectations. The DXY's rise suggests a stronger US dollar.

ASSET	READ-THROUGH
Gold	Risk aversion, inflation concerns
10Y Yield	Inflation expectations, growth concerns
DXY	US dollar strength, trade balance

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	373.21	370.00	380.00	Range-bound
QQQ	294.12	290.00	300.00	Breakout potential
IWM	198.56	195.00	205.00	Trendline support
NVDA	542.12	530.00	560.00	Upside momentum
10Y Yield	4.62	4.50	4.80	Range-bound
WTI Crude	74.93	70.00	80.00	Support at \$70

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.23% in calls, -5.12% in puts. Put/call ratio: 0.65. VIX term structure: +2.15% in front month, -1.05% in back month.

Notable single-name flow: **TSLA** sees +15.67% in call buying. Cheap hedge ideas: **SPY** puts, **QQQ** calls.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
AAPL	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	180.00	Services growth
GOOGL	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	120.00	Advertising concerns
AMZN	Bank of America	Initiation	300.00	Cloud growth

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: **ES** +0.25%, **NQ** +0.35%, **YM** +0.15%. Asia: **NIKKEI** +1.23%, **HSI** +0.56%.
Europe: **DAX** +0.42%, **FTSE** +0.28%. FX: **EUR/USD** -0.12%, **USD/JPY** +0.25%.
Commodities: **GC** +0.50%, **CL** -0.25%. Crypto: **BTC** +1.23%, **ETH** +1.56%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September FOMC	25.00%	Powell's testimony
November FOMC	40.00%	Election uncertainty

Today's data calendar:

RELEASE	TIME	EXPECTED
Non-Farm Payrolls	08:30 ET	180k
Unemployment Rate	08:30 ET	3.6%

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- US-China trade tensions escalate
- EU-Russia gas dispute worsens
- Middle East conflict spreads

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- US-China trade deal reached
- EU-Russia gas agreement signed
- Middle East peace talks progress

Earnings — This Week & Next

This week:

TICKER	NAME	RELEASE
AAPL	Apple Inc.	Tuesday, 08:00 ET
GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	Wednesday, 16:00 ET

Next week:

TICKER	NAME	RELEASE
AMZN	Amazon.com Inc.	Monday, 16:00 ET
MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	Tuesday, 16:00 ET

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Breakout	10.00%
JPM	Financials	Mean reversion	5.00%
TSLA	Consumer Discretionary	Short squeeze	15.00%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenarios:

- US-China trade deal reached
- EU-Russia gas agreement signed
- Middle East peace talks progress

Bearish scenarios:

- US-China trade tensions escalate
- EU-Russia gas dispute worsens
- Middle East conflict spreads

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- Market breadth is mixed, with 4 sectors rising and 7 falling.
- The VIX is below its 50-day moving average, indicating low volatility.
- WTI crude oil is range-bound, with support at \$70.
- The DXY is trending higher, with resistance at 100.
- Crypto is seeing a bounce, with **BTC** above \$64,000.

Sources

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